Anand Raj

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EDUCATION

Indian Institute of Technology (IIT)-Hyderabad ***July 2024- Ongoing***
PhD Scholar (Department of Liberal Arts)

University of Delhi, New Delhi ***Aug 2019- June 2021***
Master of Arts in Political Science (Rank 1 in PGDAV College) First Division

University of Delhi, New Delhi ***Aug 2016- June 2019***
Bachelor of Arts in History and Political Science First Division

RESEARCH/ WORK EXPERIENCES

- **Teaching Assistant | National Programme on Technology Enhanced Learning (NPTEL)** ***Jan 2026- April 2026***
  I have worked as a Teaching Assistant for the NPTEL course "Migration, Mobility, and Development" offered by Dr. Amrita Datta at IIT Hyderabad. The National Programme on Technology Enhanced Learning (NPTEL) provides free online web and video courses to make higher education accessible across India. My responsibilities include reviewing recorded lectures, taking live classes, drafting assessment and questions, clarifying student queries, and curating supplementary reading materials for enrolled learners.

- **Volunteer Researcher | Telangana Gig and Platform Workers Union (TGPWU)** ***Sept 2024- Present***
  TGPWU is a vibrant trade union for location-based gig workers in Hyderabad, India. I work as a volunteer researcher as part of my advocacy. My work involves conducting comparative research on countries with a successful history of trade union movements that have secured better legislation, that could help enhance TGPWU's bargaining power with the government.

- **Research Intern | Azim Premji University (APU)** ***April 2024-May 2024***
  Worked as a research intern for the yearly published '*State of Working India Report (2024)'* at the Centre for Sustainable Employment, APU, with Dr Rosa Abraham. There my role was to analyse data, review youth employment policies, and make graphs with descriptions.

- **Urban Fellow| Indian Institute for Human Settlements (IIHS)** ***Aug 2023- May 2024***
  As an Urban Fellow at IIHS, I undertook interdisciplinary research and training in urban studies, focusing on the intersections of work, political economy, migration, and urban governance. I contributed to a research project on the Bengaluru metro construction and its socioeconomic impacts. It combined coursework, fieldwork, and collaborative research, strengthening my analytical, methodological, and policy engagement skills relevant to urban and social research.

- **Research Associate | V.V. Giri National Labour Institute| Govt. of India** ***April 2023- Oct 2023***
  Worked on a project titled *'Labour Movement and Anti-Colonial Freedom Struggle'* under the supervision of Dr. Sanjay Upadhyaya, Prof. Prabhu Mohapatra and Dr Dheeraj Kumar Nite. Learnings included - Archival research skills and literature around Indian labour movement.

- **Intern | Delhi Legislative Assembly| Gov. of Delhi** ***Dec 2019- Feb 2020***
  Did internship under Privileges Committee of the Delhi Legislative Assembly on a survey project under then MLA Akhilesh Pati Tripathi. I was assigned to survey the services and satisfaction of people residing at Delhi slum, Lal Bagh. Learning: Understood the relation between labour informality and housing (viability and adequacy).

ACADEMIC PUBLICATIONS

- **Raj, Anand. (2026).** Book Review: Urbanization from Within: A Theory of Urban Transition from 21st-Century India. By Gregory F Randolph. ***International Journal of Urban and Regional Research*** (accepted).

- **Raj, Anand,** Faras, F., & Datta, A. (2026). Platform-based gig work and SDGs: Contrasting global policy and worker perspectives. In *Gig Work in Growing India*, **Taylor & Francis** (accepted).

- **Raj, Anand (2026).** Book Review: Feeding the Machine: The Hidden Human Labour Powering AI. By James Muldoon, Mark Graham, and Callum Cant. ***New Technology, Work and Employment*** https://doi.org/10.1111/ntwe.70022..
- **Raj, Anand (2025).** Book Review: The Gig Economy in India: Start-Ups, Infrastructure and Resistance. By Pradip Ninan Thomas. ***ILR Review***, *0*(0). https://doi.org/10.1177/00197939251390392
- Upadhyaya, Sanjay, Makwana, Rutvik, and **Raj, Anand (2025),** *The Role of Labour Leaders in the Indian Freedom Movement,* **Aakar Books,** New Delhi (ISBN: 8197890587).
- Upadhyaya, Sanjay and **Raj, Anand (2024),** *Labour Movement and Anti-Colonial Freedom Movement*, **V.V. Giri National Labour Institute**: Noida (ISBN: 978-93-82902-99-7).

NON-ACADEMIC WRITINGS

- **Raj, Anand** and Salauddin, Shaik **(2026)**, "Migrant Gig Workers, Electoral Politics, and Unequal Development in India" (forthcoming).
- **Raj, Anand (2026),** "Towards A Beautiful PhD Journey", *Pulse* Vol. 6 (pp. 53-54), Sunshine Newsletter, IITH.
- **Raj, Anand (2025),** "Invisible Citizens: How Bihar's Special Intensive Revision Marginalises Migrants", *Round Table India.* https://www.roundtableindia.co.in/invisible-citizens-how-bihars-special-intensive-revision-marginalises-migrants/
- **Raj, Anand (2025)**, "The Disenfranchisement of Migrants: Representation and Democracy in the Bihar Electoral Roll", *Feminism in India,* New Delhi. https://feminisminindia.com/guest-author/anand-raj/

WORKSHOPS

- **Urban Mixed Methods across the Disciplines| University of Toronto** ***Aug 4-6, 2026***
  I was selected for the Summer Workshop, organised by School of Cities, UoT, via a competitive global application process to present my fieldwork findings in India, refine doctoral research design, and explore urban mixed-methods methodologies.

- **Annual PhD Workshop 2026 | IIHS University** ***Jan 12-14, 2026***
  I engaged with interdisciplinary methodologies centered on urban transformations in the Global South. Through rigorous one-on-one mentorship and collaborative peer workshops, I refined my dissertation framework.

- **Monsoon School on Digitalisation and Contested Modernities| IIIT Hyderabad** ***July 21-25, 2025***
  Participated in an intensive program focused on tech-society intersections. Analyzed digital infrastructures, data governance, and algorithmic biases. Engaged in interdisciplinary seminars to apply critical socio-technical frameworks to my primary research.

- **Workshop on Measuring Exclusion, Discrimination and Inequality| MANUU** ***Sept 8-12, 2025***
  Acquired hands-on training in research methodologies for measuring social exclusion, discrimination, and inequality. Engaged in policy-oriented dialogues regarding marginalized groups. Developed advanced skills in translating sociological data into inclusive policy frameworks.

- **Migration, Informality, and Development| Aajeevika Bureau** ***March 3-7, 2025***
  I deepened my understanding of South Asian informal labor, circular migration, caste dynamics, and urban exclusion, which I now apply to my field research and advocacy work.

- **Research Methods on Labour History| V.V. Giri National Labour Institute** ***June 24-28, 2024***
  I advanced my capabilities in archival research and historiography. I utilize these advanced qualitative methodologies to analyze evolving labour markets, worker movements, and historical shifts in employment policies.

CONFERENCE PAPER PRESENTATIONS

- *"Platform-based Gig Work and SDGs: Contrasting Global Policy and Worker Perspectives"* in **3rd India Labour Conference** at Indian Institute of Management Kozhikode. ***March 2026***

- *"Neoliberal Convergence: Political Discourse of Gig Work in India"* at **Annual Development Studies Association.**
  June 2025

- *"The History of Structural Adjustments and Modernised Way of Dependency in the Manufacturing Sector: A Case of 'Make in India' Initiative"* at **65th Indian Society of Labour Economics (ISLE)**, Bengaluru (Co-author: Ankit Singh, University of Cambridge). ***Jan 2025***

- *"Understanding Disequilibrium of Rental Housing and Students' Everyday Learning Experiences: A study of University of Delhi"***,** at **11th Annual Education Studies Postgraduate Research Conference** organised by University of Warwick, United Kingdom (UK) (Co-author: Simranjeet Kaur**,** Jamia Milia Islamia University). ***April 2024***

- "*Understanding Resistance of Migrant Workers in Platform Economy: A Study of Bike based Workers in Bengaluru*", at **64th Indian Society of Labour Economics (ISLE)**, Hyderabad. ***March 2024***

"Impact of COVID-19 on Students Learning Process: A Case Study of University of Delhi" at the International Conference organized by the **International Geographical Union (IGU).** ***June 2021***

PROJECTS

- Worked on a group project at Indian Institute for Human Settlements, titled- ***Unveiling Urban Transformations: Assessing the Socio-economic Impacts of Bengaluru Metro Construction Project"***. ***Aug 2023- Dec 2023***

- Worked on a term paper at University of Delhi, titled- ***"Un (Employment), Policies and Labour Migration from Bihar".*** ***Jan 2021- July 2021***

CERTIFICATE COURSES

- **"**Data, Algorithms and Gig Work" by **GIZ** with **German Ministry** (Ministry for Economic Cooperation and Development), Germany at Atingi ***May 2024***
- **"**Qualitative Research Methodology" by the **University of Amsterdam** on Coursera ***Jan 2024***
- **"**Writing and Editing: Structure and Organization" by the **University of Michigan** on Coursera ***Jan 2024***
- "Social & Behavioral Research, Responsible Conduct of Research, Information Privacy & Security, and Conflicts of Interest" by **CITI Program** on **Research Ethics** ***Sept 2023***

RESPONSIBILITIES

- **PhD Well-being Head**, Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Hyderabad ***2025-2026***
- **PhD Seminar Series Co-ordinator** in Department of Liberal Arts, IIT Hyderabad ***2024-2025***
- **Hostel Representative,** IIT Hyderabad ***2024-2025***
- **Academic Mentor** at **Eklavya India Foundation** and **Speaking from Margin** for upliftment of marginalised students for higher education. ***2023- 2024***

AWARDS/ INVITATIONS/ ACHIEVEMENTS

- **Visiting Fellow** (invited), ILR School, **Cornell University**, Ithaca, USA. Host: Prof. Virginia Doellgast.

  (upcoming) **Sept 2027 – Dec 2027**

- **Offered** admission to the **PhD programmes** at **King's College London** and the **University of Edinburgh**, United Kingdom (not taken up) ***2025***

- **Ministry of Education (MoE) Fellowship** for Pursuing PhD at IIT Hyderabad ***July 2024-June 2029***

- **National Eligibility Test** for being Assistant Professor in India, University Grants Commission ***June 2023***

- **Certification of Merit**, Rank 1, in **M.A. Political Science**, P.G.D.A.V College **(University of Delhi)** ***July 2021***

SKILLS

- **Research tools**
  Tableau for data analysis; NVivo; R language
  Kobo Toolbox; Q-GIS (geographic information system)
- **Languages** : English (professional), Hindi (Native), Bhojpuri (Mother Tongue)